



GUIDE FOR NEW STUDENTS

2026/2027

Your first steps at Técnico and in Lisbon

A practical guide to help you in your first days,
find important information and know where to look for support.

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NEW STUDENT GUIDE

Welcome to Técnico!

NEAIST congratulates you on taking this important step towards achieving your goals. As the representative body for African students at Técnico, NEAIST works to support your integration, accompany you throughout your journey and help with any questions you may have.

Now that you are part of Técnico, you will face many new challenges along the way. As part of the NEAIST Mentoring Programme, we created this guide to bring together useful information for your first steps in Lisbon.

Your first steps

- ☐ Complete your enrolment
- ☐ Activate and start using Fénix
- ☐ Get your public transport pass
- ☐ Find accommodation
- ☐ Get your NIF
- ☐ Register with the SNS
- ☐ Check your situation with AIMA, if applicable
- ☐ Explore NEAIST resources
- ☐ Ask to join the new students' group
- ☐ Request a mentor, if you would like one

You do not have to sort everything out on your first day. Use this guide as a reference and take things one step at a time.



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1. Enrolment at Técnico

Enrolment should be completed at the academic services office for your campus.

Alameda: [Contacts | Área de Graduação • AG](#)

Taguspark: [Contacts | Área Académica e de Pessoal do Taguspark • AAPT](#)

On the day of enrolment, ask the academic services office for your **Sub23 declaration** and **enrolment certificate**. These documents can also be found on Connect at: <https://fenix.tecnico.ulisboa.pt/fenixedu-smarties/my-processes>, after signing in through Fénix.

Public transport

If you are 23 or younger, check the current conditions of the **Passe Gratuito Jovem** and the **navegante card** to find out whether you are eligible for free public transport. Always confirm the latest requirements and procedure on the official website.

Navegante: [check current information](#)

2. Fénix and digital tools

Fénix is Técnico's main academic platform. This is where you will find your course unit pages, timetables, lecturers, announcements, assessment dates, assessment methods and grades.

Get into the habit of checking it regularly, especially the pages of the course units you are enrolled in.

Want to get to know Fénix better?

Check the **Fénix 101 — NAPE Guide**, where you will find a visual and more detailed explanation of the platform's main features.

[Fénix 101 — NAPE Guide](#)





3. ULisboa Social Support

The University of Lisbon Social Welfare Services (**SASULisboa**) provide several forms of student support, including:

- canteens and food services;
- information about scholarships;
- university residences;
- other social support services.

SASULisboa: [check services and current information](#)

4. Finding Accommodation

As a first option, student residences can be a good place to look for accommodation, particularly because they are closely connected to the student community.

• University of Lisbon Residences

Técnico has two student residences available to students, one associated with the Alameda campus and another with Taguspark. In addition, ULisboa has several other student residences across Lisbon.

You can find more information about university accommodation and applications here:

<https://www.sas.ulisboa.pt/introducao-ao-alojamento>

Other accommodation options

You can also look for rooms, shared flats or private student residences. Before making any payment, always confirm the accommodation conditions, the existence of a contract and the identity of the person or organisation responsible.

Técnico's International Affairs services also provide information about accommodation providers and options for the international community. The listed providers are suggestions, so always check the applicable conditions yourself.

Accommodation — Técnico/AAI: [view information](#)



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Private rooms and shared accommodation

You can also rent a room or share a house or flat. You can search on websites such as [imovirtual.com](https://www.imovirtual.com), [custojusto.pt](https://www.custojusto.pt), [casa.sapo.pt](https://www.casa.sapo.pt), [olx.pt](https://www.olx.pt), [bquarto.pt](https://www.bquarto.pt) as well as Facebook groups.

You can also check the noticeboards in the Alameda Central Building, where students and visitors may post notices about available accommodation in different parts of the city.

Avoid making payments or bank transfers before confirming that the listing, the person responsible and the accommodation conditions are legitimate.

5. Registration with your local Parish Council

It is highly recommended that you obtain proof of residence from the **Junta de Freguesia** corresponding to the area where you live.

Having official proof of your address in Portugal can be useful throughout your stay and for different administrative procedures.

More information is available here:

<https://www.comparaja.pt/blog/atestado-de-residencia>

6. Getting your Portuguese Tax Identification Number (NIF)

The **NIF — Número de Identificação Fiscal** — is the Portuguese Tax Identification Number and is required for several administrative procedures in Portugal.

Técnico's **International Admissions Office (NAI)** supports international students with the process of obtaining a NIF.

Prepare copies of the following documents:

- **Passport;**
- **Proof of address in your country of origin**, in your name and clearly showing your address;
- **Proof of admission or enrolment at Técnico**, for example:
 - your admission letter; or
 - your Técnico student card, if you already have it.

Take these copies to the **NAI**. The team will support you through the process and provide or arrange the appointment needed for you to obtain your NIF from the Portuguese Tax Authority.



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Once you arrive in Portugal, go to the NAI with copies of your documents. After they have been checked, you will receive information about the next steps required to complete the process with the **Portuguese Tax and Customs Authority (AT)**. You will need to present the original documents at that appointment.

As requirements may vary depending on your individual situation, always confirm the most up-to-date information with the NAI.

NAI — support for the international community: [view information](#)

7. Registration with the National Health Service (SNS)

Registering with the **SNS — Serviço Nacional de Saúde (National Health Service)** is important so that you can access public healthcare services.

You should register at the health centre corresponding to your place of residence. If you move, you should update your registration according to your new address.

- You will first need an **SNS user number (número de utente)**. More information: [Request an SNS user number — ePortugal.gov.pt](#)
- You can then complete your registration. More information: [Register with a health centre](#)

8. Residence Permit

If you need to deal with an issue related to your residence permit, start by completing the **AIMA Contact Form**.

AIMA Contact Form — [open form](#)

On the form:

1. select “**Autorização de Residência**” under “**Tipo de Assunto**”;
2. under “**Subtipo de Assunto**”, select the option applicable to **Higher Education Students**, according to your situation.

Different procedures may apply depending on your type of visa or request, so make sure you select the option that corresponds to your situation.

For additional questions or support when contacting AIMA, you can also contact the **International Admissions Office (NAI)**. NAI supports Técnico's international community with matters related to visas, residence permits and communication with AIMA.

NAI Email: international.admissions@tecnico.ulisboa.pt

Official AIMA information — Higher Education Students (Article 91): [view requirements](#)

The information in this guide is intended to help you organise your first steps at Técnico and in Portugal.



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Some procedures vary depending on your nationality, admission route and individual situation. Whenever you are unsure, confirm the information directly with the official services indicated throughout this guide.

The steps outlined in this guide are intended not only to help you settle into Lisbon, but also to support a good quality of life and ensure that your stay in Portugal is properly regularised.

And remember: your experience at Técnico goes far beyond the classroom. Take part in activities, get to know the community and make the most of the academic, cultural and social opportunities you encounter along the way.

STAY CONNECTED

Explore NEAIST, find useful resources and keep up with our initiatives.



Visit our website

neaist.tecnico.ulisboa.pt

Follow us on Instagram

[@nea_ist](https://www.instagram.com/nea_ist)



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TÉCNICO

YOU'VE MADE IT TO TÉCNICO. NOW MAKE IT YOUR PLACE.

Starting university in a new country brings change, challenges and many firsts.

But this stage is also about new friendships, opportunities, discoveries and growth.

Make the most of Técnico: learn, take part and create memories.

And remember: you do not have to go through this journey alone. NEAIST is here to welcome you, support you and walk alongside you.

COMMUNITY · SUPPORT · OPPORTUNITIES

Welcome to Técnico.

Welcome to NEAIST.